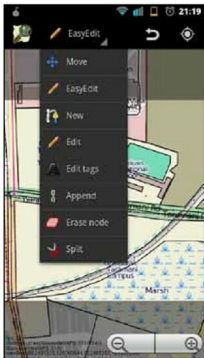




Downloading map data on OSMAnd



Vespucci interface on Android



Vespucci map edit tools

Paths represent ways or roads. For example, a highway, a cycling path or a trekking trail can be represented using paths. Railway lines are paths too. Large enclosed areas are shapes or *polygons*. Even large buildings, islands, parks, playgrounds, etc. can be represented as polygons.

The actual properties of a node, path or a polygon can be given from within the editor itself. Properties for a highway, for instance, are width, number of lanes, surface type, whether or not the road is a one-way, etc.

You can do mapping using GPS coordinates, uploading GPS tracks/traces, or tracing over satellite imagery.

GPS co-ordinates

The GPS or geographical coordinates of a particular entity on the ground that is denoted by a latitude-longitude number (latlong) can be noted down, and then manually added on the map.

GPS traces

These are continuous traces of the paths you've travelled on with the GPS device on, continuously monitoring your position. This creates trace files that can be uploaded to OSM and integrated into the base map. The GPS coordinates and traces can be obtained by any GPS-enabled phone with the necessary software, or a GPS device that has a USB interface that you can use to transfer trace files to your computer. If you're planning to buy one, check out the OSM Wiki page for GPS device reviews.

Tracing over aerial imagery

This method is for crude mapping in places where accuracy is not an *immediate* concern. You can simply bring up the aerial map from Bing (yes, Microsoft Bing!) as a background image to trace structures onto the OSM layer.

Important: Tracing over aerial imagery is very error-prone. Never attempt to correct existing map data to match with aerial imagery. Satellite images have parallax errors, and are

far from accurate. So unless absolutely necessary (like when trying to map a very remote rural place), *do not* attempt to trace. GPS-based methods are the most accurate.

Editing OSM using Potlatch

Potlatch is an in-browser Flash-based map editor for OSM. You can use it to add data to the map without the need for any special software. The only requirement is to have the Adobe Flash plug-in for your browser.



Note: The Gnash plug-in does not seem to work. If you are particular about not installing Flash/proprietary software, just skip to the JOSM section below.

Once you have zoomed in to the location that you want to edit, click the *Edit* link on the top, and enter your credentials to log in to OSM. (You've registered by now, haven't you?)

Once you're logged in, Bing's aerial imagery shows up in the background; you can choose from the drop-downs to either sharpen the background, or do away with it. Now, add nodes by double-clicking at a single point. You can add paths by clicking a trace path and double-clicking at the last node. To create a closed polygon, simply click on the first node after you've created all the other nodes.

After creating a node or a path, you can add *properties* to it by choosing an appropriate one from the panel on the left-hand side. You can also drag the points into the map to directly place a particular entity on the map. Try clicking the tabs to see the various properties that you can give to the nodes. As mentioned earlier, nodes are often called Points of Interest (POI) in OSM lingo.

To undo something, hit *Backspace* or *Delete*; Backspace removes nodes one by one, in the reverse order. Or simply click on the final node, path or shape, and hit *Delete* to remove it. Maps can be dragged using 'click-drag' even while editing the map.

Once you're done editing the